

Request for Information (RFI)
DARPA-SN-26-52
Satellite Power and Thermal Capability

Responses Accepted: Until 4:00 p.m. (Eastern) on March 27th, 2026

Point of Contact: Lt Col Andrew Small

Email Address: DARPA-SN-26-52@darpa.mil

The Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA) is requesting information related to space companies' ability to produce satellites for Low Earth Orbit (LEO), Medium Earth Orbit (MEO), Geosynchronous Earth Orbit (GEO), and Cislunar Orbits which can provide medium to high levels of Orbital Average Power (OAP) to the payload.

BACKGROUND

The U.S. space sector is undergoing a transformation and over the past few years, several organizations have developed the ability to produce LEO, MEO, GEO, or Cislunar satellites that provide high levels of OAP. These advancements provide opportunities to develop new capabilities in support of the DARPA mission.

REQUESTED INFORMATION

This RFI seeks responses to the below questions for high power-consumption applications (e.g. Space Data Centers). You may respond to one or more of these questions.

Question 1:

- a) How many satellite buses will your organization launch into LEO between 2025-2030 (by year) that provide more than 3kW of payload OAP? What is your predicted production rate by quarter?
- b) How many satellite buses will your organization launch into LEO between 2025-2030 that provide more than 10kW of payload OAP? What is your predicted production rate by quarter?
- c) What is the Technology Readiness Level (TRL) and Manufacturing Readiness Level (MRL) of your LEO satellite bus?
- d) What are the expected internally funded and government-funded cost, technical, and schedule risks associated with your planned production?

Question 2:

- a) How many satellite buses will your organization launch into Medium Earth Orbit (MEO) between 2025-2030 (by year) that provide more than 5kW of payload OAP? What is your predicted production rate by quarter?
- b) How many satellite buses will your organization launch into MEO between 2025-2030 that provide more than 20kW of payload OAP? What is your predicted production rate by quarter?
- c) What is the TRL and MRL of your MEO satellite bus?
- e) What are the expected internally funded and government-funded cost, technical, and schedule risks associated with your planned production?

Question 3:

- a) How many satellite buses will your organization launch into Geosynchronous Earth Orbit

(GEO) between 2025-2030 (by year) that provide more than 5kW of payload OAP? What is your predicted production rate by quarter?

- b) How many satellite buses will your organization launch into GEO between 2025-2030 that provide more than 20kW of payload OAP? What is your predicted production rate by quarter?
- c) What is the TRL and MRL of your GEO satellite bus?
- f) What are the expected internally funded and government-funded cost, technical, and schedule risks associated with your planned production?

Question 4:

- a) How many satellite buses will your organization launch into a Cislunar Orbit between 2025-2030 (by year) that provide more than 5kW of payload OAP? What is your predicted production rate by quarter?
- b) How many satellite buses will your organization launch into the Cislunar domain between 2025-2030 that provide more than 20kW of payload OAP? What is your predicted production rate by quarter?
- c) What is the TRL and MRL of your Cislunar satellite bus?
- g) What are the expected internally funded and government-funded cost, technical, and schedule risks associated with your planned production?

Question 5:

- a) What methods or technologies do your satellites on orbit use to manage payload cooling?
- b) Provide an overview of your company's experience in designing, manufacturing, and testing active and passive thermal control systems for satellites with OAP exceeding 3kW (LEO) or 5kW (MEO/GEO/Cislunar)
- c) What is the TRL and MRL of your thermal control systems?
- d) What is your experience or perspective on emerging thermal control technologies such as:
 - Variable emissivity surfaces (thermochromic or electrochromic)
 - Embedded cooling and on-die cooling solutions for electronics
 - Rollout or inflatable radiators

SUBMISSION FORMAT

Respondents to this RFI are encouraged to be as succinct as possible, while also providing useful insight. Page-limit is four pages in addition to cover page. Format specifications for responses include 12-point font, single-spaced, single-sided, 8.5 by 11-inch paper with 1-inch margins, in MS Word or Adobe PDF format. Tables and figures that concisely convey information are allowed and encouraged.

A. Cover Sheet (1 page): Provide the following information.

- a. Response Title,
- b. Technical point of contact name, organization, telephone number, and email address,
- c. Names, organizations and email addresses of anticipated collaborators.
- d. List whether the respondent is a U.S. citizen, U.S. person (Green card holder; please list other citizenship), or foreign national (not a U.S. person, please list other citizenship).

B. Technical Description: At least 1 page, 4-page maximum. This should be focused on concise answers to the 3 questions in the Requested Information section.

To the maximum extent possible, respondents are encouraged to send non-proprietary information; if proprietary information is included, respondents are responsible for clearly identifying such information. Responses containing proprietary information must have each page containing such information clearly marked with a label such as “Proprietary” or “Company Proprietary.”

SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS AND CONTACT INFORMATION

All responses to this RFI must be emailed to DARPA-SN-26-52@darpa.mil. Responses will be accepted any time from the publication of this RFI until the response date stated on Page 1. Early responses are highly encouraged. All technical and administrative correspondence and questions regarding this RFI should also be sent to the same email address. Emails sent directly to the program manager may result in delayed/no response. If the file size with references exceeds 10 MB, email DARPA-SN-26-52@darpa.mil to request a link to submit files up to 1 GB in size.

Classified background and information, if any, are also of interest. DO NOT INCLUDE ANY CLASSIFIED INFORMATION IN THE RFI RESPONSE. Send an email to DARPA-SN-26-52@darpa.mil indicating an intent to submit a classified response; DARPA will respond with follow-up instructions.

ELIGIBILITY

DARPA invites participation from all those engaged in related research activities and appreciates responses from all capable and qualified sources including, but not limited to, universities, university-affiliated research centers (UARCs), Federally Funded Research and Development Centers (FFRDCs), private or public companies and Government research laboratories.

DISCLAIMERS AND IMPORTANT NOTES

- This is an RFI issued solely for information and new program planning purposes; it does not constitute a formal solicitation for proposals. In accordance with FAR 15.201(e), responses to this RFI are not offers and cannot be accepted by the Government as such.
- Responses do not bind DARPA to any further actions related to this topic including requesting follow-on proposals from respondents to this RFI.
- Submission is voluntary and is not required to propose to a subsequent Broad Agency Announcement (BAA) (if any) or other research solicitation (if any) on this topic.
- DARPA will not provide reimbursement for costs incurred in responding to this RFI.
- Respondents are advised that DARPA is under no obligation to acknowledge receipt of the information received or provide feedback to respondents with respect to any information submitted under this RFI.
- DARPA will disclose submission contents only for the purpose of review. Submissions may be reviewed by the government (DARPA and partners) and scientific, engineering and technical assistance (SETA) support contractors.